

Mattau Health

Health worker

Health information for every village in
Papua New Guinea.

More topics

- Safe Motherhood
- TB
- Malaria
- Healthy Family, Healthy Community
- Healthy Village
- Policies

This site gives general health information. If you or someone in your family is sick, go to your nearest health centre or talk to your village health worker.

Safe Motherhood

You link mothers to antenatal care, support emergency deliveries when there is no other choice, and refer early.

For health workers

Key messages

- Know every pregnant woman in your catchment and encourage early antenatal visits.
- Help each family make a birth plan: where to deliver, transport, who will go with her, and what to bring.
- Check for danger signs at every home visit and refer without delay.
- Assist an emergency delivery only when a facility cannot be reached, then refer mother and baby.
- Follow up after the birth: mother, baby, breastfeeding, immunisation, and family planning counselling.

Refer immediately if she has

- Heavy bleeding before, during or after birth
- Severe headache, blurred vision or fits
- Fever or foul-smelling discharge
- Reduced or no baby movement
- Early rupture of membranes without labour
- Prolonged labour

Run a village session

1. Meet in a shaded, central place at a time when families can come. Greet everyone and say what today's topic is.
2. Ask what people already know and what they have heard. Listen first.
3. Share three key messages from this page in your local language. Use pictures and real examples from the village.
4. Ask people to say the messages back in their own words, and answer questions.
5. Agree on one action the village will take this month. Refer anyone who is unwell,

and record who came.

General information only. Follow the advice of your health centre and current national guidelines.

TB

TB DOTS means watching each patient take their medicine so that the treatment works. Community support is a big part of the cure.

For health workers

Key messages

- Ask about cough at every home visit. Refer anyone who has coughed for two weeks or more for testing.
- Support DOTS: help each patient take every dose, keep appointments and collect refills.
- Watch for side effects and missed doses and tell the health facility early.
- Screen household contacts, especially children.
- Reduce stigma. TB is curable, and patients need support from their family, not fear.

Refer straight away if a patient has

- Coughing blood
- Difficulty breathing
- Missed medicine for several days
- Serious side effects, such as yellow eyes or repeated vomiting
- A child in the household with a long cough or weight loss

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Malaria

Test before you treat. A rapid test lets you confirm malaria in the village and give the right treatment.

For health workers

Key messages

- Test every person with fever using a rapid diagnostic test where available.
- Treat positive cases following the current national guideline, and check the full course is taken.
- Refer severe cases, and refer sick young children and pregnant women early.
- Promote bed net use, and teach families to clear places where mosquitoes breed.
- Record tests, treatments and referrals in your register.

Refer immediately if the patient has

- Fits, confusion or unusual sleepiness
- Cannot drink or keeps vomiting
- Very pale or yellow
- Fast or difficult breathing
- Fever in a pregnant woman or a baby

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Healthy Family, Healthy Community

Monthly awareness sessions help families and whole communities build the everyday habits that keep people well. Use the 16 cell indicators for families and for communities to guide each session.

For health workers

Key messages

- Wash hands with soap or ash after using the toilet and before handling food.
- Use a toilet, keep water covered and clean, and dispose of rubbish safely.
- Make sure every child is fully immunised.
- Sleep under a bed net, and take pregnant women for antenatal care.

- Eat a variety of foods from the garden, and weigh children under five.
- Care for the elderly and for people with disabilities, and include them in village life.

Talk to the health facility if you see

- A child who is very thin or not growing
- Many people in a village with the same sickness
- A household with no safe drinking water
- A mother who has not been seen for antenatal care

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Healthy Village

Community-based planning is how a village takes ownership of its health. Community trust and ownership are what make health programmes last.

For health workers

Key messages

- Help the village make a simple health plan and review it regularly.
- Work with village leaders, church groups and women's groups.
- Support projects that improve water, sanitation and food.
- Link the village to the health centre and to visiting outreach teams.
- Collect simple health data and report it every month.

Raise with the health facility if

- There is an outbreak or many people are sick at once
- The village cannot reach the health centre because of the road or river
- Supplies you rely on have run out

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Policies

The policies behind your work, in plain language.

For health workers

Key messages

- The National Health Plan 2021–2030, Volume 1B, lists Village Health Assistance as Intervention No. 1.
- It is one of 10 interventions in the plan meant to drive five Key Result Areas.
- The plan moves the volunteer role (VHV) toward a recognised Village Health Assistant (VHA) role.
- Your primary roles are to link the community to health facilities through referral, to coordinate health services in your catchment area, and to promote health and prevent illness.
- Field recommendations include fast-tracking the VHA policy, district-level ownership by the provincial health



authority, incentives to keep VHAs in their communities, and stronger logistics and supervision.

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